Sergi Gonzalez

Senior Software Engineer · Team Lead

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Summary

Product-minded engineer and team lead with 15+ years building software for startups and scale-ups, remote since 2018. Grew two teams from scratch, built a chat platform serving 130K+ concurrent users at Letgo, co-founded a startup, and led an international team at Coralogix. Currently building open-source tools spec-first with AI coding agents. Open to remote senior backend or team lead roles from January 2027.

Skills

Languages: Rust, Scala, TypeScript

Backend & Architecture: Distributed systems, event-driven architecture, microservices, DDD/CQRS, Kafka, gRPC

Infrastructure & Observability: Kubernetes, AWS, Terraform, Prometheus, Grafana

Data: MySQL, PostgreSQL, Elasticsearch, DynamoDB

AI-assisted development: Claude Code, Codex, spec-driven development

Frontend (working knowledge): Angular, React

Experience

Sabbatical and personal projects **Jan 2026 – present**

Career break

- Planned break after Coralogix, including parental leave.
- Built Yarrtube, an open-source self-hosted YouTube synchronizer (Rust, React, TypeScript), spec-first with Claude Code and OpenSpec. 200+ GitHub stars.
- Currently building Superthree, a self-hosted TV channel for kids where parents schedule what plays (TypeScript).

Software Engineer, Data Usage Team **May 2025 – Dec 2025**

Coralogix – Remote

B2B observability SaaS that grew from about 100 to 500+ employees between 2022 and 2025. Moved to the team that meters each customer's platform usage and enforces quotas.

- Helped replace the legacy JavaScript quota blocker with a new Rust service that warns customers approaching their quota and blocks ingestion within minutes of them exceeding it.
- Added per-data-type blocking rules (logs, metrics, traces) and quota sharing between data types.
- Built customer-facing usage dashboards on usage data aggregated from Kafka into ClickHouse.

Team Lead, Dashboards Team **Apr 2022 – May 2025**

Coralogix – Remote

Promoted shortly after joining the company to found and lead the dashboards team, acting as its engineering manager.

- Built custom dashboards, a Grafana-like product that became the platform's native alternative to Grafana for customers and replaced it company-wide for internal service monitoring.
- Grew the team from 1 to 6 engineers, mostly frontend (Angular), owning hiring and performance management.
- Delivered the home dashboard and took over Explore, the product's highest-traffic page (log exploration).
- First frontend team at the company to adopt end-to-end testing (Playwright); other teams followed.
- Main contributor to the team's backend (Scala) and infrastructure (Kubernetes), hands-on in the Angular frontend.

Co-Founder **Nov 2020 – Jan 2022**
Cassette – Remote
Bootstrapped startup founded with three former Letgo colleagues. Desktop and mobile app for asynchronous meetings over voice notes, aimed at replacing daily stand-ups.

- Built the backend (Scala) and the desktop app (Electron, TypeScript), and ran the AWS infrastructure, including voice-note transcription with Amazon Transcribe.
- Reached about 100 sign-ups and 5 teams running daily stand-ups on it, steered by regular user interviews.
- Pitched investors and wound the company down after 14 months without funding or product-market fit.

Staff Engineer, Platform Team **Aug 2018 – Oct 2020**
Letgo – Remote
B2C second-hand marketplace for the US market that raised about $1 billion and grew to 300+ employees. Proposed the platform backend team to the CTO and moved into it, as one of three engineers.

- Built the PHP and Scala libraries that every backend team used to publish and consume domain events, standardizing how 40 engineers integrated their services.
- Introduced service quality tracking across backend teams, covering SLAs, downtime and test coverage.
- Built a company-wide domain event explorer, used by backend teams for debugging and by customer care.
- Moved the company's event backbone from SNS and SQS to Kafka.
- Ran backend recruiting with the platform team, hiring 20+ engineers across both Letgo roles.

Team Lead, Chat Team **Oct 2015 – Aug 2018**
Letgo – Barcelona

- Built the new real-time chat in Scala and Akka (WebSockets, MariaDB), which peaked at 130K+ concurrent users and handled over 4 billion messages.
- Migrated from the PHP chat with zero downtime, running both in parallel for months and keeping them in sync through domain events over SQS.
- Scaled it with Akka Cluster and archived older messages to DynamoDB as volume grew.
- Led the company-wide move to an event-driven microservices architecture. Every backend team adopted domain events (SNS, SQS) and owned its own database, built from projections.
- Grew the team from 1 to a cross-functional squad of 8 and began co-leading hiring for the backend department.

Earlier roles – Software Engineer **2010 – 2015**
Akamon (2014–15), Atrápalo (2011–14) and others

Talks

- Microservices Anti-Patterns, Bilbostack 2020 (slides, ES)
- From Polling to Real Time, BCN Software Crafters 2017 (slides, EN)
- DDD as an Implementation Detail, PHP Barcelona 2015 (slides, EN)

Education

Universitat Autònoma de Barcelona (UAB), BSc in Computer Science 2010

Languages

Catalan and Spanish (native), English (fluent; led an international team in English, 2022–2025)